VolunTime Feedback for Jason

Oct 27, 2026 · @Dillon Workman

Jason, we really, really love VolunTime, and we're so excited about where it's headed. It already covers what we used Clockify for, and it does things Clockify never could for us: in-kind value built right in, group sessions, and the Needs board. Thank you for the care you've put into it.

This is my feedback after reviewing the staging site, grouped by area. Where a request builds on something the app already does, I've noted what's there now so you can see the gap.

The last two sections are a few bugs and cleanup items we spotted along the way, plus questions where I'd like your take before you build.

Roles and access

We need three levels of access, each able to log time for everyone below it.

Level	Who	Can do	Closest role today
Super admin	CASWJ staff	Manage time for all groups and all volunteers. Run all reports. Submit time for group managers and volunteers.	Admin
Group manager	A leader in one or more member groups (Symphony, Youth Theatre, etc.)	Manage and submit time for everyone in their group or groups. Log a whole group's effort, or the total volunteer effort for an event.	Group coordinator
Volunteer	Everyone else	Track their own time and see their own history. Request access to more information when they need it.	Volunteer

What's new compared with the current build:

- **Group managers covering several groups.** Please confirm a coordinator can be assigned to more than one group and see combined reports.
- **Event-level totals.** Group sessions today are tied to a group. We also need to log the total volunteer effort for one event, such as a show night with 40 helpers, without entering each person.
- **Requesting access.** A volunteer should be able to ask for more access from inside the app, and an admin approves or declines it.
- **Custom roles.** It would be great to have a permissions table where admins can adjust what each role can do and create new roles as we need them, instead of a fixed set.

Inviting and importing people

Right now an invite only asks for an email and a role. We'd like the admin to set up the person's name and username when they send the invite.

- **Name fields.** Add first name and last name to the invite form.
- **Automatic username.** Create the username from the first initial plus the last name, so Jane Smith becomes jsmith. If that's taken, tell the admin and add a number at the end (jsmith1, jsmith2). The invite email should then tell the person their username.
- **Invitation subject line.** Something like "CASWJ invited you to join VolunTime," with preview text such as "Log your volunteer hours with the Cultural Arts Society of West Jordan." The wording is open, so feel free to improve it.
- **Review before sending.** When people are imported, show a list of names, usernames, email addresses and groups so the admin can confirm it before mass invitations go out. Please also make clear whether importing sends invitations automatically.
- **Duplicate check on import.** The Import screen says existing records are skipped, but it doesn't say how a match is found. In that review list, flag rows that match existing people or projects, including near-matches like the same name with a different email, so the admin can skip, merge or import each one.
- **CSV templates.** Add a "Download template" link for the People and Project / Events imports so we know which columns to use.
- **Drop the Groups import.** We'll rarely add groups, so it isn't needed. Adding them one at a time on the Groups screen is fine.

Projects and events

The project dropdowns are already long, and they'll keep growing every season.

- **Archive old projects.** An archived project or event stays in reports and past entries but no longer appears in dropdowns. The hourly rates screen already works this way, so the same pattern would fit.
- **Add a project from any dropdown.** Wherever someone picks a project or event (logging time, group sessions, Needs), add a "+ New project / event" option so they don't have to go to Settings first. It could be limited to admins and group managers.

Needs

I love publishing Needs. For it to bring in new volunteers, though, people need to see the openings before they have an account.

- **A public Needs page.** Anyone can browse the open public needs without logging in, then send a sign-up request from there.
- **What's there now.** The Add need form already has "Allow a public sign-up link." A link for each need is a good start, but a single page listing all public needs is what we'd share on wjarts.org and social media.
- **Group managers can post needs.** A group manager can create a need for their own group. It goes to an admin for approval before it's published, and the manager hears back either way.

- **Vetting.** The "Require vetting" option and the custom questions already fit this flow well.

Classifying time and the dashboard

Grant reports are only as good as how people classify their hours, so a few prompts would help a lot.

- **After stopping the timer.** Show a short reminder to check the project, task category and group before saving.
- **Unclassified entries.** An entry with no project, no task category and no group counts as unclassified. Notify people about these entries, asking them to classify the time or delete the entry.
- **Tags.** Admins keep managing the tag list so we can add more detailed tracking later. If there are no tags, hide the Tags field from users.
- **Clickable dashboard cards.** Each card should open the detail behind it. For example, clicking "Your hours" opens your entries, and clicking a category in "Hours by task category" opens the entries in that category.

Reports and exports

Reports has two fixed CSV downloads today, the Volunteer Log and the Summary. We'd like more control over what we export.

- **Export what you see.** Download the current report view, or the full log for any date range.
- **Shape it before exporting.** Add or remove columns, add filters and sorts, then export. Saving those settings as a custom report would let us rerun the same export for each grant.

Other things we noticed

- **Triple-listed groups.** Each member group is a group, a project (Literary Arts Society shows up in the event dropdown), and an "(Org)" tag. Task categories are also repeated as "(Type)" tags. This probably came from the Clockify import. Let's agree on one place for each before launch so reports don't double up.

Open questions

- ☐ Does importing people send invitations automatically?
- ☐ Can a group coordinator manage more than one group today?
- ☐ Project and task category are required today, so unclassified entries can't happen yet. Should the timer save without them so people can classify their time afterward?
- ☐ What should we call the levels? In the app, "organization" means CASWJ and "group" means the Symphony, Youth Theatre and so on. Let's match the labels to how volunteers talk.
- ☐ Is sign-up from a public Need the same as self-signup, or does it create a request an admin approves?